Ministry had to eventually clarify that no such grid failure was likely and that all systems had been put in place to avoid any chance of such a failure.[4]

States like Maharashtra were particularly active in spreading discord at a sensitive time and in retrospect it is now clear that Sardesai, who has amassed a huge following on social media owing to prime-time news anchoring, played an active role in perpetrating misleading information. Over the years, it has become clear that once considered a doyen of journalism, he routinely peddles fake news and amplifies propaganda,[5] which has the potential to harm the Modi government. Immediately after 9.00 p.m., when vigil had just about started, several media persons including Sardesai tweeted images of a fire breaking out in a building in Solapur.[6] In fact, instead of quashing such fake news, the guardian minister of Solapur from the Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) tweeted, 'There is nothing to worry about the fire near solapur airport in solapur. As guardian minister I just spoke to collector solapur and all is under control #StayHomeStaySafe.'[7] The truth however was that these images of the fire were two months old. No fire had broken out at Solapur or anywhere else due to the people's response to the prime minister's clarion call.[8]

Sardesai didn't stop here. All through the pandemic, he continued his aggressive misinformation campaign. The next day, on 6 April, he tweeted a letter from the Resident Doctor's Association at Safdarjung Hospital about them seeking donations for PPE kits, N95 masks, triple-layer masks and hand sanitizers with a note, 'What can be more appalling: resident doctors at a leading Delhi hospital seek to raise funds for protective equipment. Can't expect doctors to be soldiers at the frontline in this battle without equipment, can we?'[9] As always in his case, the truth was altered. Safdarjung Hospital, only on 4 April, two days before, had tweeted tagging the Union Health Ministry and the then Union health minister, 'There is no shortage of PPE kits, N95 masks and any other logistics in Safdarjung Hospital to fight with CORONA Pandemic. The Doctors, Nurses and all staff of Safdarjung Hospital are trying their best to beat this virus @MoHFW_INDIA, @drharshvardhan #FightAgainstCoronavirus.'[10] They were merely trying to convey to NGOs that they were accepting donations of the aforementioned medical equipment.

Sardesai's role in spreading fake news and fear-mongering eventually became a menace for India Today when he put out similar factually